

SAMUNDRA INSTITUTE OF MARITIME STUDIES (SIMS), MUMBAI & LONAVALA

Bringing revolution in maritime studies

The worldwide scarcity of well trained officers and crew is a phenomenon that has troubled the international shipping industry in recent years. However, the bigger crisis is that very little effort is being put in to prevent this catastrophic situation that the industry is facing.

However, Executive Ship Management (ESM), a leading international ship management company, has already taken the proactive step of working around the problem. The Singapore-based company with its manning headquarters in Mumbai provides exceptional training for its seafarers with the establishment of its very own training institute, Samundra Institute of Maritime Studies (SIMS). In fact, ESM is the only global ship management company with a one-nationality policy, that recruits only Indian seafarers for its managed vessels.

ESM started with the SIMS Post-Sea facility that is recognized for its world-class maritime training to existing seafarers, in 2002. Later, as a "logical backward integration", ESM invested over USD 20 million to develop a state-of-the-art, world-class Pre-Sea maritime training campus for the future generation of Indian seafarers.

Both the Post-Sea training facility in Mumbai and Pre-Sea Training campus in Lonavala (around 100km away from Mumbai) bring maritime training to a new level, which is acclaimed by the industry pundits as revolutionary and trendsetter.

The institute's Post-Sea Training Facility in Mumbai offers around 50 value-added courses to seafarers to upgrade their knowledge and keep them on top of the increasing requirement of a fast developing industry. It provides a holistic learning experience with its latest and unique hands-on learning equipment like a downsized stainless steel tank of a chemical tanker, bridge simulator with a 240-degree field of view and the main engine manoeuvring simulator amongst many others.

Certified for ISO 9001:2000 under Norwegian Classification society DNV and recognized by both the Directorate General of Shipping, Govt. of India and the Maritime and Port Authority (MPA) of Singapore, SIMS Mumbai provides international recognition to its seafarers. It is the first and only maritime training institute in India, which is running value-added training courses, approved under DG Shipping India, the Maritime and Coastguard Agency of UK, MPA Singapore as well as the maritime administrations of Marshall Islands and Liberia.

"Getting quality seafarers is a priority of the maritime community around the world, and the work done at SIMS in producing world-class seafarers is very commendable."

Mr. Noboru Ueda
Executive Vice President, ClassNK, Japan

While the institute's Post-Sea facility has established itself in the international arena, the complementing Pre-Sea campus in Lonavala was recently inaugurated on 1st November 2007. Designed and landscaped by world-renowned architects, builders, experts and artistes, the avant-garde campus covers an area well over 55 acres.

In fact SIMS Lonavala has been termed by industry leaders as the best maritime training facility in India and a top-notch facility unparalleled elsewhere in the world. The campus presently has the capacity to produce 400 cadets (both navigation and engineering) who will be future Captains and Chief Engineers

"A visionary product that will have the capability to produce the world-class maritime staff of the future."

Mr. John Ridgway
Deputy Chief
Executive of BP
Group & Chief
Operating Officer,
BP Shipping
Ltd., UK



on ships.

The campus features not only state-of-the-art facilities but also the latest equipment, which are in fact real-life machineries as found on ships and custom made simulators that are based on the type of vessels managed by ESM. The pride of the institute that now graces the skyline of Lonavala is the ship-in-campus – the stern of a real ship – is also a unique concept of providing the future Captains and Chief Engineers with an outstanding opportunity of experiencing the real sailing experience ashore.

The fact that the high calibre faculty at both the Post-Sea and Pre-Sea facilities are mostly Master Mariners or Chief Engineers by training and sailing experience, SIMS undoubtedly ensures that the training provided is far above the mandatory STCW requirements.

At SIMS, it is the commitment of the institute that each cadet and crew undergoing training leaves the institute not just with a paper qualification but also with the extra edge and competence to do the job he is assigned to his optimum potential. This in turn ensures a safer and more efficient running of ships.

